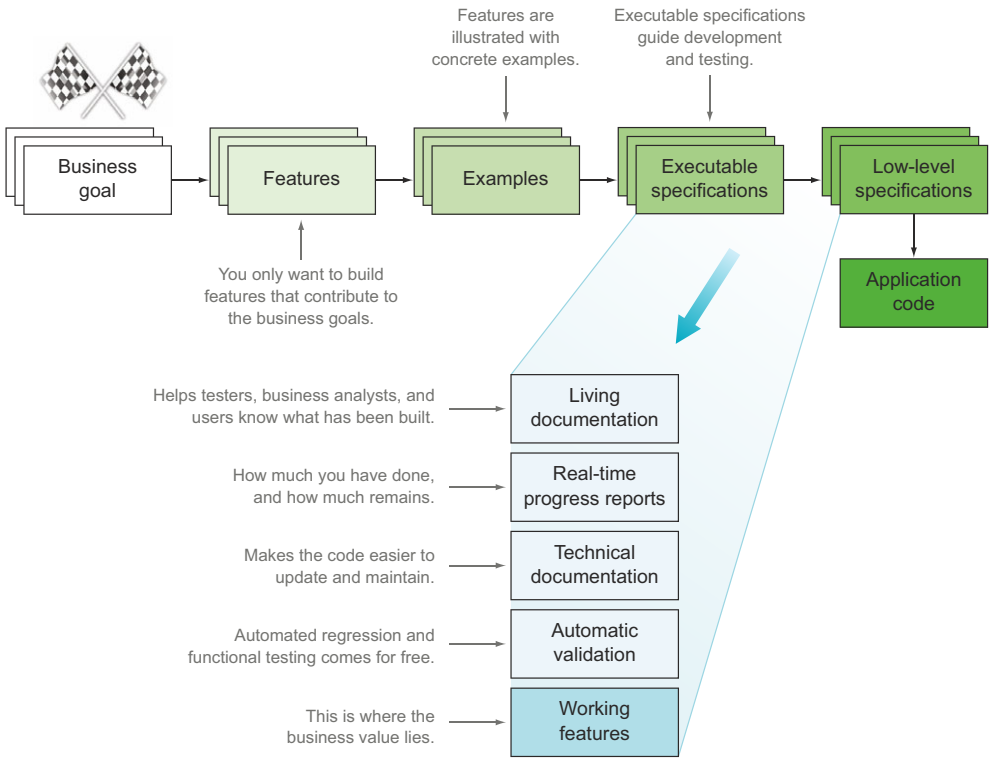



**Figure 1.6 The principal activities and outcomes of BDD. Note that these activities occur repeatedly and continuously throughout the process; this isn't a single linear Waterfall-style process, but a sequence of activities that you practice for each feature you implement.**

In the following sections, we'll look at how these principles work in more detail.

### FOCUS ON FEATURES THAT DELIVER BUSINESS VALUE

As you've seen, uncertainty about requirements is a major challenge in many software projects, and heavy upfront specifications don't work particularly well when confronted with a shifting understanding of what features need to be delivered.

A *feature* is a tangible, deliverable piece of functionality that helps the business to achieve its business goals. For example, suppose you work in a bank that's implementing an online banking solution. One of the business goals for this project might be "to attract more clients by providing a simple and convenient way for clients to manage their accounts." Some features that might help achieve this goal could be "Transfer funds between a client's accounts," "Transfer funds to another national account," or "Transfer funds to an overseas account."

Rather than attempting to nail down all of the requirements once and for all, teams practicing BDD engage in ongoing conversations with the end users and other stakeholders to progressively build a common understanding of what features they should create. Rather than working upfront to design a complete solution for